

manufacturing capabilities within the coal mining sector. At the forefront of this initiative is CIL, actively acquiring cutting-edge High Capacity HEMMs and advanced Continuous Miners.

Coal Gasification: A Vision for Sustainable Energy

Venturing into the realm of energy production, coal gasification transcends conventional methods, offering a revolutionary approach. The nation is poised to make significant strides in environmental sustainability, reducing reliance on imports of Natural Gas, Methanol, Ammonia, Urea, and other crucial products. The ambitious target of achieving 100 million tonnes of coal gasification by 2030 reflects a commitment to reducing the carbon footprint. The Coal Ministry's offer of a 50% rebate in revenue share for coal used in gasification, coupled with a separate auction window, underscores the commitment to integrating environmental considerations into the coal sector's fabric. This approach aligns seamlessly with India's broader goal of transitioning to cleaner and greener energy sources. A recent Cabinet approval has paved the way for a comprehensive scheme with a Rs.8,500 crore outlay, promoting Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects. Cabinet has also approved the proposals for equity investments for the establishment of a Coal-to-SNG Project at ECL command area through a joint venture of CIL & GAIL, and a Coal-to-Ammonium Nitrate Project at MCL command area through a joint venture of CIL & BHEL.

Corporate Social Responsibility-Serving Humanity

In alignment with the 'Good Governance' ethos advocated by the Hon'ble Prime Minister, the PSUs of Ministry of Coal have significantly increased their CSR expenditure by 51.43%, reaching Rs.546.04 Cr. in FY 2022-23, compared to Rs.360.5 Cr. in 2014-15. Over the past decade, from 2014 to January 2024, Coal India Limited and other PSUs have collectively allocated approximately Rs. 5,300 crore towards CSR initiatives.

Sustainable Development and Greening Initiatives

Striking a delicate balance between meeting the nation's surging energy demands and upholding an unwavering commitment to environmental preservation, the coal sector takes a pioneering role in adopting progressive strategies for sustainable afforestation and bio-reclamation. The extensive bio-reclamation and afforestation endeavours aim to fortify both the carbon sink and green cover. Over the last 10 years, Coal PSUs have successfully brought about 18,849 Ha of land under green cover by planting an impressive 42.3 million saplings. This pioneering initiative underscores the coal sector's unwavering commitment to responsible and environment friendly sustainable coal mining practices.

Eco-parks & Mine Tourism

Former mining areas, post-exhaustion of coal reserves, hold promise for tourism development through eco-parks, mine tourism sites, water sports, underground tours, golf courses, recreational spots, adventure activities, and bird watching. Over the past decade, including the current fiscal year, Coal India Limited and other PSUs have transformed over 28 hectares of land into eco-parks using sustainable mine closure practices. Seven of these parks have been seamlessly integrated into local tourism circuits. These repurposed mining sites are now stable, environmentally sustainable, and visually appealing. Looking ahead, Coal India Limited and other PSUs aim to establish an additional 23 eco-parks and mine tourism sites in the near future.

Gainful Utilization of Mine Water

Rise in population along with rapid urbanization & industrialization has put severe pressure on available water resources. Coal/Lignite PSUs are doing their bit to address the issue of water in and around the mining areas. They have supplied approximately 16,012 Lakh Kilo Litre (LKL) of treated mine water for community purposes in the last four years from 2018, benefitting over 17.7 Lakh people in 981 villages of 9 states every year and also creating irrigation potential of 173,000 acres of agriculture land annually. Coal India Limited and other PSUs has set target of 4250 LKL for gainful utilization of mine water for community use – drinking as well as irrigation purpose.

Promoting Renewable Energy

Coal companies are going for both rooftop solar and ground mounted solar projects, particularly in some of the reclaimed mining areas. As on March 2023, Coal/lignite PSUs have installed solar capacity of about 1696.36 MW and wind mills of 51 MW. It is planned to install 5560 MW of renewable capacity by FY26.

India's coal sector is undergoing a comprehensive and strategic overhaul, guided by Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi's dynamic leadership. The multifaceted approach, spanning production, environmental care, logistics, and social responsibility, signifies a paradigm shift towards self-reliance. As India continues its pursuit of 'AtmaNirbhar Bharat', the coal sector stands as a key contributor to the nation's progress, driven by a vision of efficiency, responsibility, and resilience. This transformative journey sets the stage for a sustainable and self-sufficient future in the coal and mining industry.

In this transformative journey, every policy reform, every tonne of coal produced, and every innovative initiative contributes to shaping not just an industry but a legacy of sustainability and self-reliance. As the coal sector evolves, guided by a vision of a cleaner, greener, and more resilient future, it remains a beacon of progress in India's journey towards a balanced and sustainable energy landscape.

